Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall and Electronically
At 1:00 p.m. on December 11, 2023

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Chair – Regional Councillor	M. Crawford
	Regional Councillors	S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		N. Henry
		L. Bower
	Mayor	S. Collier

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Chair Crawford called the meeting to order at 1:02 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

On behalf of Council, Chair Crawford extended condolences to the Collier family on the loss of Mayor Collier's mother.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interests.

3. Adoption of Minutes

3.1 Regular Meeting

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held November 20, 2023 be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Consent Agenda

Members separated items 4.2, 4.3, 4.5, 4.6, 4.7, 4.8, 4.9 and 4.11 for discussion.

4.1 CAO-2023-24: Memorandum of Understanding with Toronto and Region

Conservation Authority

Moved by: S. Collier

That Council authorize the Mayor and Clerk or their designates to execute the attached Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) between the Town and the Toronto and Region Conservation Authority.

CARRIED

4.2 **CAO-2023-20: Corporate Workforce Census**

Committee Members asked questions regarding the number of racialized individuals employed by the Town, barriers to hiring people born outside of the country, blind resume screening, timelines associated with the implementation of blind hiring practices, diversity in leadership positions at the Town, census frequency, census administration, historical data collected, workforce census findings, internship opportunities for racialized groups, success of the Shooting Star bursary program, implementation strategies and timelines, diversity benchmarking, next steps, accommodations available to individuals with learning disabilities. Natasha Sharma, Diversity & Inclusion Coordinator and Mary Lou Cosentino, Manager of Human Resources Services, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: L. Bower

That the report entitled “Corporate Workforce Census” be received for information.

CARRIED

4.3 **CAO-2023-21: Contract Extension – Benefits Provider**

Committee Members asked questions regarding costs and timelines associated with the extension. M. Cosentino responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Lee

That Staff renew the current contract for medical, dental, life insurance and long-term disability benefits with the current provider to Sun Life Financial in the estimated amount of 5,212,913.84 (inclusive of taxes), for a period of one-year effective January 1, 2024.

CARRIED

4.4 **CAO-2023-25: Downtown Ajax and Pickering Village Business Support Framework**

Moved by: S. Collier

That the Downtown Ajax and Pickering Village Business Support Framework be received for information.

CARRIED

4.5 **FIN-2023-25: Surety Bond Pilot Program Review**

Committee Members asked questions regarding rationale for the proposed term of the program extension. Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer, responded to the question from Committee Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That the Surety Bond Pilot program be extended for an additional 5 years.

2. That staff be directed to report back to the General Government Committee by January 2029 regarding the success and/or challenges related to enabling the development community to submit surety bonds as a form of development security.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Lee

That recommendation #1 be amended from 5 years to 3 years and recommendation #2 be amended by replacing "2029" with "2027".

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That the Surety Bond Pilot program be extended for an additional 3 years.

2. That staff be directed to report back to the General Government Committee by January 2027 regarding the success and/or challenges related to enabling the development community to submit surety bonds as a form of development security.

CARRIED

4.6 **FIN-2023-28: 2023 Operating Budget Forecast**

Committee Members asked questions regarding the library surplus allocation, ice time availability, rationale for parking fine revenue loss, strategies to rectify staffing challenges, slots revenue, and Elexicon revenue. D. Valentim, Chris Vida, Director of Recreation & Culture, and Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative & Information Services/Clerk, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

That the Report on the 2023 Operating Budget Forecast be received for information.

CARRIED

4.7 **PDS-2023-40: Residential Parking Permit Feasibility Study – Request for Information (RFI) Update**

Committee Members asked questions regarding timelines associated with a town-wide

Parking Master Plan (PMP). Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: N. Henry

1. That the report titled “Residential Parking Permit Feasibility Study – Request for Information (RFI) Update” be received for information.

CARRIED

4.8 **PDS-2023-42: Delegation of Durham Region Land Division Responsibilities**

Committee members had no questions for staff.

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That Council delegate the authority for the granting of consents to the Town of Ajax Committee of Adjustment, and that the by-law delegating such authority, as provided in Attachment 1 to this report, be presented to Council at its meeting on December 11, 2023 for approval; and

2. That the proposed by-law to amend the Town of Ajax Fees and Charges By-law, as provided in Attachment 2 to this report, be presented to Council at its meeting on December 11, 2023 for approval.

CARRIED

4.9 **LIS-2023-18: Changing Start Time for Council and Community Affairs & Planning (CAP) Meetings to 1:00 p.m.** (*Mayoral Direction No. 3*)

Committee Members asked questions regarding whether consideration was given to commencing meetings at 9:30 a.m., opportunities for public participation, and opportunities to reschedule meeting start times if necessary or deemed appropriate. N. Cooper responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the regular start time for Council Meetings and Community Affairs and Planning Committee Meetings be moved to 1:00 p.m., effective February 1, 2024; and

2. That the Clerk be directed to bring forward amendments to the Council Procedure By-law and the approved 2024 meeting schedule, in January 2024, to reflect this change.

CARRIED

4.10 **LIS-2023-16: 2023 – 2026 Multi-Year Accessibility Plan – Mission: Inclusion**

Moved by: S. Collier

That the 2023-2026 Multi-year Accessibility Plan – Mission: Inclusion be endorsed.

CARRIED

4.11 **LIS-2023-17: Election Sign Deposit Program**

Committee Members asked questions regarding compliance requirements for federal and provincial candidates, sign placement and violations, accessibility barriers, procedures for the removal of illegal signs, and remedies available to the Town if the election sign deposit is exhausted. Derek Hannan, Manager of By-law Services, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

That staff be directed to bring forward changes to the Town's Election Sign By-law to include an "Election Sign Deposit Program" as outlined in this report by the end of the Q1 of 2024.

CARRIED

5. Discussion

None

6. Presentations

With the consent of Members present, item 6.2 was advanced in the order business.

6.2 LIS-2023-18: Customer Service Strategy

N. Cooper introduced Ian Shelley, Partner, Blackline Consulting.

Council recessed at 1:58 p.m.

Council resumed at 2:01 p.m.

Ian Shelley, Blackline Consulting, delivered a presentation regarding the Customer Service Strategy. I. Shelley discussed approach, stakeholder consultation, current customer service practices, customer service operations, customer service work volume including call volumes, customer service options, the vision for customer service at the Town of Ajax, key themes, Customer Service principles, role of staff, pillars of the customer service strategy identified as Define the Experience, Deploy the Tools and Elevate the Delivery, and implementation timelines.

Committee Members asked questions regarding call recording, function of the customer service experience team, and customer service standards. N. Cooper and I. Shelley, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That the 2023 Customer Service Strategy (ATT-1) be endorsed by Council in principle; and

2. That any projects and initiatives identified therein for future years be considered as part of the annual budget process.

CARRIED

6.1 PDS-2023-41: Planning & Development – Development Application Review Teams

G. Romanowski delivered a presentation regarding Development Application Review Teams. G. Romanowski discussed background, principal concerns, principle objectives, Development Application Review Teams framework, application volume, staff resources, Development Application Review Teams structure, new contract staff positions required, Pilot Year 1 statistics and results, and next steps.

Committee Members asked questions regarding the future of the Development Application Review Teams structure (once the backlog is cleared), timelines associated with the pilot, number of contracted staff, and rationale for pre-pilot lengthy processing timelines. G. Romanowski responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That the report titled “P&D – Development Application Review Teams Pilot” be received for information.

CARRIED

6.3 CAO-2023-19: Consolidated Report on Core Services Reviews

Christie McLardie, Manager of Public & Strategic Affairs, provided a brief overview of the Core Services Reviews including background information, and introduced Alice Orange, Project Manager, Grant Thornton.

A. Orange delivered a presentation regarding the Core Services Reviews and discussed objectives, approach, steps taken to date, primary research findings, key drivers, key themes, and key focus areas.

Committee Members asked questions regarding the dedicated Customer Relationship Management (CRM) system, timelines associated with the implementation of CRM, and strategies to track and manage recommendations. N. Cooper and Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Consolidated Report on Core Services Reviews be received for information.

CARRIED

Closed Session (3:00 p.m.)

7. Authority to Hold a Closed Meeting and Related In-Camera Session

Moved by: S. Collier

That Council convene to a Closed Session pursuant to Sections 239 (2) (b) and (d) of the Municipal Act, 2001, as amended, to discuss personal matters about an identifiable individual, including municipal or local board employees and labour relations or employee negotiations.

CARRIED

7.1 **Proposed Organizational Structure Changes**

7.2 **Fire Service Dispatch Negotiations**

Council recessed at 3:00 p.m.

Council resumed at 3:05 p.m.

Open Meeting (4:28 p.m.)

Ratify Actions Taken In-Camera

Moved by: N. Henry

That all directions approved during the Closed Session be ratified.

CARRIED

7.2 **Fire Service Dispatch Negotiations**

Moved by: N. Henry

1. That the Mayor and the Clerk be authorized and directed to execute an agreement to outsource fire call taking and dispatch services to the City of Oshawa (ATT-1).

2. That the costs associated with the outsourcing be included in the 2024 operating budget, as described in the Financial Implications section.

3. That the CAO be authorized to take the necessary steps to terminate the dispatch agreement with Pickering by mutual agreement of the parties at the appropriate time.

4. That the Chief Administrative Officer be directed and authorized to, at his discretion, take any other necessary actions or enter into any other required agreements to give effect to the outsourcing of Fire Service Call Taking and Dispatch Services to the City of Oshawa.

CARRIED

8. Adjournment (4:30 p.m.)

Moved by: L. Bower

That the December 11, 2023 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

CARRIED